

Tulsi Manas Mandir

Tulsi Manas Mandir (Hindi: तुलसी मानस मंदिर) is one of the most famous temples in the holy city of Varanasi. This temple has great historical and cultural importance in Hinduism since the ancient Hindu epic *Ramcharitmanas* was originally written at this place by Hindu poet-saint, reformer and philosopher Goswami Tulsidas in the 16th century (c. 1532–1623).^{[1][2]}

History

One of the famous Hindu epics, *Ramayan* was originally written in Sanskrit language by Sanskrit poet Valmiki between 500 and 100 BC. Being in Sanskrit language, this epic was not accessible to and understood by masses. In the 16th century, Goswami Tulsidas wrote the *Ramayan* in Awadhi dialect of Hindi language and the Awadhi version was called *Ramcharitmanas* (meaning Lake of the deeds of Rama).^{[3][4][5]}

In 1964, the Sureka family constructed a temple at the same place where Goswami Tulsidas wrote *Ramcharitmanas*.^[1]

Construction

Construction finished in 1964 and was funded by the Thakur Das Sureka family of Bandhaghat, Howrah, West Bengal. The temple was constructed in white marble and landscaping all around the temple. Verses and scenes (pictorials) from *Ramcharitmanas* are engraved on the marble walls all over the temple.^{[1][5]}

Tulsi Manas Mandir

तुलसी मानस मंदिर



Religion

Affiliation Hinduism

District Varanasi

Deity Rama

Location

Location Durga Kund, Bhelupur, Varanasi

State Uttar Pradesh

Country  India



Temple location on Varanasi district map

Coordinates 25.287206°N 83.000417°E

Architecture

Creator Sureka family of Howrah, West Bengal, India

Completed 1964

Elevation	85 m (279 ft)
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Entrance to the temple.



Figurines in Tulsi Manas Mandir

Location

Tulsi Manas Mandir is situated on the Sankat Mochan road, 250 meters south of Durga Kund, 700 meters north-east of Sankat Mochan Mandir and 1.3 kilometers north of Banaras Hindu University.^[6]

Historical importance

Due to Ramcharitmanas, the epic Ramayan was read by larger number of people, who otherwise could not have read Ramayan since it was in Sanskrit. Reportedly, prior to Ramcharitmanas, the depiction of Lord Rama as Supreme God was quite subtle in Valmiki's Ramayana (as most of the Hindu religious scriptures are highly subtle in their meaning giving scope for more personal interpretation) but in Tulsidas's Ramcharitmanas this depiction was more obvious than Valmiki's Ramayana .^[7] The temple was inaugurated by Sarvepalli Radhakrishnan. The temple houses a museum with rare collection of manuscripts and artifacts.^[8]

See also

- [Durga Mandir](#)
- [Hindu temples in Varanasi](#)

References

1. "Tulsi Manas Mandir" (<http://www.varanasi.org.in/tulsi-manas-mandir-temple-Varanasi>). Varanasi.org. Retrieved 1 March 2015.
2. K.B. Jindal (1955), *A history of Hindi literature* (<https://books.google.com/books?id=IkA9AAAAIAAJ>), Kitab Mahal, "... The book is popularly known as the *Ramayana*, but the poet himself called it the *Ramcharitmanas* i.e. the 'Lake of the Deeds of Rama' "
3. "History" (<http://www.bharatonline.com/uttar-pradesh/travel/varanasi/tulsi-manas-mandir.html>). bharatonline.com. Retrieved 1 March 2015.
4. Vālmīki, Robert P. Goldman (1990). *The Rāmāyaṇa of Vālmīki: An Epic of Ancient India* (<https://archive.org/details/ramayanaofva01valm/page/14>). Vol. 1. Princeton University Press. pp. 14–15 (<https://archive.org/details/ramayanaofva01valm/page/14>). ISBN 0-691-01485-X.
5. "Tulsi Manas Temple" (<http://www.varanasicity.com/temples/tulsi-manas-mandir.html>). Varanasi City website. Retrieved 1 March 2015.
6. "Location" (<https://www.google.co.uk/maps/dir/Shri+Satya+Narayan+Tulsi+Manas+Mandir,+Durga+Kund+Sankat+Mochan+Rd,+Near+Jalan,+Durga+Kund,+Tulsi+Manas+Mandir+Colony,+Naria,+Varanasi,+Uttar+Pradesh+221005,+India/@25.2799202,83.0002224,14z/data=!4m9!4m8!1m0!1m5!1m1!1s0x398e31f3a5a3f463:0xd69495ede9e8c29f!2m2!1d83.000395!2d25.28722!3e0>). Google Maps. Retrieved 1 March 2015.
7. "Importance" (<http://www.indianmirror.com/temples/tulsi-manas-temple.html>). Indian Mirror. Retrieved 1 March 2015.
8. Karkar, S.C. (2009). *The Top Ten Temple Towns of India*. Kolkata: Mark Age Publication. p. 10. ISBN 978-81-87952-12-1.

External links

- [Why Tulsi Manas Mandir is importance for us || History of Tulsi Manas Temple](https://www.janobanaras.com/why-tulsi-manas-mandir-is-importance-for-us-and-history-of-tulsi-manas-temple/) (<https://www.janobanaras.com/why-tulsi-manas-mandir-is-importance-for-us-and-history-of-tulsi-manas-temple/>)

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